

MONEY HABITS AND SYSTEMS

So far we've looked at your Money Story and Money Environment, which tell us about the nurture component of your unique Financial Phenotype, and your Money Type, or the nature component. Hopefully, you've started to understand and recognise your own Financial Phenotype through answering the questions in the recap chapters at the end of Parts One and Two.

But as you know by now, I don't want this to simply be a cute concept or a fun thing to do. Sure, it's interesting to learn new theories and to play around with personality tests to understand who we are. Our ego and sense of self love that. But how does that help us financially in our day-to-day lives?

What happens on a Sunday night, when the stress of the week you're about to start kicks in, you haven't had a chance to prepare food for the week and everything in you wants to scream, 'F*ck it! I'm just going to buy takeaway for every meal this week as well as purchasing something pretty online.' What happens when you're disillusioned with your job or your life and you decide that you need to buy something to feel better, so you spend more than you can afford? What happens when the fear of global catastrophes, what is happening politically and global unrest cause you to hoard any resources you might have and to press pause financially because you're scared to take action? (You can insert whatever your own version of stress-induced spending, or non-spending, looks like.)

How does understanding your Financial Phenotype help then?